

Book II - The Spiral and the Block

Part 1 - The True Republic

Chapter 05 - Who Owns Your Life

EP02 — Who Owns Your Life?

Series: True Republic **Type:** Street / Campus Interview **Core Question:** "Who owns your life?"

The Seed Being Planted

Self-ownership is the foundation of all libertarian and voluntaryist ethics. Most people intuitively believe they own themselves — but they've never examined whether their relationship with the state is consistent with that belief.

If you own yourself, no one has the right to your labor, your body, or your choices without consent. If someone else owns you, that is the definition of slavery — even if it's called taxation, conscription, or licensing.

Interview Arc

Opening Question

"Who owns your life?"

Follow-Up Questions

- "So you own yourself?"
- "Does that mean you own the product of your labor?"
- "If someone takes a portion of your paycheck without asking — what do we call that?"
- "What if a large group votes to take it — does the vote change the nature of the act?"
- "If you own your body, should you be allowed to put whatever you want into it?"

- "Who gets to override the owner of a life — and by what right?"

The Contradiction That Often Emerges

People will affirm self-ownership and then defend government programs that require overriding it. The moment of discovery: either you own yourself or you don't. There's no partial ownership that isn't just a different word for controlled.

Cold Open Script (Narrator)

"There are two possible answers to this question. Either you own your life — or someone else does. Everything in politics follows from which answer you give."

Closing Narration

The shaken jar makes us argue about *who* should own us. The living question is whether any external party has a legitimate claim on a life they didn't create, sustain, or consent to serve.

Source Quotes

Direct quotes from Sage's own writing to draw from when scripting this episode.

"You were made to be ruled. This statement is true — but not in the way the world has taught it. You were not made to be ruled by other humans. You were not made to be ruled by institutions, empires, or systems. You were made to live under the rule of the Creator alone."

"No one group should have the monopoly on the right to use violence. Each person has the right to use violence in very specific cases — the defense of others and themselves and their property. This is the only case violence is justified."

"It is every person's duty to uphold what is right in all they do. This must always be the highest priority — never to be sacrificed for power, wealth, or fame."

"Each person must stand firm in their convictions, refusing to cower before false authority. There is no rightful chain of command among men — all are equal, all are independent. No human being is born with the right to rule another."

"Humans are free because they are true slaves. Humans are owned by God and there can only be one master so no other can take that role over another."

"Better to be a criminal for doing what is right than follow the law by committing an atrocity."

The Living Age Trilogy